

WILLIAM WU

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EDUCATION

University of California, Berkeley, CA
Bachelor of Arts in Astrophysics and Computer Science
GPA 3.860
Expected Spring 2026

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, Advisor–Yuhan Yao, University of California, Berkeley 2025 - present
Reducing and analyzing UV/optical light curves and spectral data for tidal disruption event AT2021gje to determine its standing in the broader population

Research Assistant, Advisor – Carmine Cella, Center for New Music and Audio Technologies 2025 - present
Worked on machine learning methods to infer parameters given an input sound for use with physical modeling synthesis

Research Assistant, Advisor–Raffaella Margutti, University of California, Berkeley 2024 - present
Using X-ray telescopes such as SWIFT to image tidal disruption events. Reducing data and analyzing lightcurves and spectra to fit for physical information during the X ray plateau, monitor late time evolution, and search for quasi periodic eruptions.

Research Assistant, Advisor–Greg Aldering, Lawrence Berkeley National Lab 2024 – present
Working on imaging data from the SuperNova Integral Field Spectrograph (SNIFS) to assess dimming due to clouds or hardware issues, and to assess the seeing. Using PanSTARRS and GAIA to spatially align the images and obtain the image zeropoints.

Research Assistant, Advisor–Alex Filippenko, University of California, Berkeley 2024 - present
Observing with the Nickel 1m telescope at Lick Observatory and scanning supernovae candidates from Zwicky Transient Facility data

ACADEMIC PROJECTS

Electric Avenue 2024
Developed a pedagogical web app to teach basic network thinking

To the Sun Carillon Performance 2025
Developed server backend for time synchronization and front-end interactive web app for an interactive carillon concert sonifying Parker Probe data.

METALSTIGMATISM 2025
Created a direct and global illumination raytracer in Metal including monte-carlo estimation, bounding volume hierarchies, Russian roulette, and adaptive sampling for real-time display in the Apple vision pro

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

School Nova 2020-2021
Teaching Assistant – Math 7a, 7b

University of California Berkeley
Undergraduate Student Instructor – Astron 7AB Summer 2024
Undergraduate Student Instructor – Astron C10 Fall 2024
Undergraduate Student Instructor – Physics 8A Spring 2025

OUTREACH

Kits Cubed STEM fair – performed various demos for children at a science fair
UAS Star Parties – Operated various telescopes for outreach events
Astro Night – Operated the Richard Treffers telescope for public outreach events

EXTRACURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

Port Jefferson, NY

Development Team Lead - PJ Current (local student run newspaper) 2019 – 2022

University of California, Berkeley

Member – Outlet RSO 2022 - 2024

Member – Dance Games @ Berkeley RSO 2022 – present

Telescope Crew – Undergraduate Astronomy Society RSO 2023 – present

Member – Cal Wushu 2024 – 2024

Member – 3D Modeling and Animation RSO 2024 – present

Member – Golden Records RSO 2024 - present

OTHER SKILLS

Programming proficiency in Java, C, RISC-V, x86, C#, python, HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Scheme, SQL, C++, GLSL, and Golang